

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-0zgf-u9d3
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-7011

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

The United States government should not be supporting the use of generative AI or LLMs nor should it support companies like OpenAI. These technologies have shown themselves to be totally unreliable and harmful again and again. The use of this technology will only lead to greater inefficiency in every aspect of public and private life. AI such as ChatGPT “hallucinates” false data more frequently than not. Generative AI has created a virtual industrial revolution of misinformation and manipulation, being used to create fake news, propaganda, deep fakes, falsified evidence, and just straight up god awful “art”.

There has been a handful of instances where LLMs have been useful such as its use in detecting cancerous cells or tracking research data in the Amazon rainforest. However, in these cases, the LLMs used were trained on data sets containing only data, collected by researchers knowledgeable about the area of study, relevant to the LLM’s assigned task such as being shown non-cancerous and cancerous cells in order to identify subtle differences between the two.

What datasets do models such as ChatGPT, Grok, Stable Diffusion, etc. use? They use copyrighted material without permission from the copyright holder. The datasets used in these models are filled with stolen data. If the companies responsible for these models wish to use the copyrighted material, they need to secure permission to do so from the copyright holders. If the copyright holders do not give permission for their materials to be used as training data, then it should not be used as training data. Instead of even asking to permission to use the materials, the companies behind these models simply scraped all the data they could find. They stole it. They stole it to train a model to create hallucinations and slop and they’re selling it as the future.

When challenged by courts about their theft, they say that their models require all that stolen data to continue. Maybe that’s true. It doesn’t change the fact that the data was stolen, and following along with lawsuits shows that the courts mostly see it as theft. To avoid having to pay for their theft as well as trying to compete with a foreign company with a similar but cheaper and better product (although still harmful), they petition the Trump Administration to basically give them immunity. OpenAI CEO Sam Altman claims it’s about national security. It’s clearly not. He is trying to save his skin and ensure that he and his company continue to make more and more money off the backs of creators.

GenAI is championed by liars, grifters, the greedy, the corrupt, and the just plain stupid. By supporting GenAI and believing in the lies peddled by its owners, the US government shows the world that it’s the same way.